

A.D. 1617. being, or the *Chief Justice of Chester* to bee one) by Fyne, Ymprisonment, Wearing of Papers and the like, according to their Discretion; But if any shall offend in so high a nature as may tend to the Danger or Dishonor of his *Majesty* or the State, Then the said *Lord President* and *Counsell* shall forbear to proceed thereupon, and shall certify his *Majesty* or the Lords of his Privie Counsell of the Case, and thereupon shall doe as they shall bee in that behalfe directed.

And whereas divers Persons of Wales and the Marches of the same, and in other the Countreys and Places aforesaid, have commonly used to go as well to Churches as in Fayrs, Markets and other Places of publique Meetinge, in Harnesse and Privy Coats: The *King's Highnes* Pleasure is, that from henceforth no Man shall wear either Harnesse or Privy Coate in Churches Fayres or Markets, or any other place of publick meeting, except such as shall be lycenced authorysed or commanded by the *King's Highnes* or his Honorable Privie Counsell, or by the *Lord President* or *Vice-President* and *Counsell* as is aforesaid, or any three of them (whereof the *Lord President* or *Vice-President* for the tyme being, or the *Chief Justice of Chester* to be one) or by the publique Officer of the Place where any such Fayre Market or publique Meeting shall happen to bee: And in case that any Man shall do contrary to this Article; That then the Officers and Ministers to whome it shall appertain, where any such Harnesse or Privie Coat is worn, shall incontinently seaze or cause to be seazed the said Harnesse or Privie Coat to the *King's Majesty's* Use, and then send the Persons wearing the same to the *Lord President* or *Vice-President* and *Counsell* as is aforesaid, to bee punyshed by Ymprisonment and Fyne according to the Discretions of the said *Lord President* or *Vice-President* and *Counsell* for the tyme being, or any three of them (whereof the *Lord President* or *Vice-President* for the tyme being, or *Chief Justice of Chester* to be one) and in case the said Officers and Mynisters do omit so to do, then the said *Lord President* or *Vice-President* and *Counsell* as is aforesaid, or any three of them (whereof the said *Lord President* or *Vice-President* for the tyme being, or the *Chief Justice of Chester* to be one) after notice and information thereof given, shall adresse the *King's Majesty's* Letters of Comandement to

such Officers and Ministers, command- A.D. 1617. ing them and him to appear before them at a day to be appointed, to answer thereunto, and shall thereupon proceed to examine hear and punish the said Offenders by Fyne and Ymprisonment, according to the Discretion of the said *Lord President* or *Vice-President* and *Counsell* as is aforesaid, or any three of them, wherof the *Lord President* or *Vice-President* for the tyme being, or the *Chief Justice of Chester* to be one.

And further his *Majesty's* Pleasure is, and his Highnes doth, by these Presents, give full Power and Authoritie to the *Lord President Vice-President* and *Counsell* as is aforesaid, or any two of them (whereof the *Lord President* or *Vice-President* for the tyme being, or the *Chief Justice of Chester* to be one) to make and cause to be made Proclamations in his Highnes Name, as often as they shall think good for the better order and quyeting of his *Majesty's* Subjects within the Principalities, Marches, Counties, Cities, Limits and Jurisdiccions aforesaid, and for the apprehending and suppressing of Malefactors and Misdoers, after such Tenor and form as they shall think convenient, and to punish the Offendors for their Contempts against such Proclamations by Fyne or Ymprisonment as the Case shall requyre.

And his *Majesty's* further Pleasure is, and his Highnes doth, by theis Presents, give full Power and Authoritie to the said *Lord President Vice-President* and *Counsell*, or any three of them (whereof the *Lord President* or *Vice-President* for the tyme being, or the *Chief Justice of Chester* to be one) to hear and determyne, and also to punish all manner of Persons within all and every the Limits and Jurildiccions aforesaid, which shall be notoriously known to live contrary to God's Lawes, and the *King's Highnes* Ecclesiastical Lawes, in Incest Adultery or Fornycacion, to the Offence and Dishonour of Almighty God, and to the evil and pernicious Example of his Highnes Subjects; Provided alwaies, and his *Majesty's* Meaning is, that no Person shall be called in question by the force of this Article for any the Offences aforesaid: unles the same Offences shall be alledged and proved to be done or commyt- ted within the space of three Years next before Information therof given, nor that any such Offendor shall be examyned upon Oath: Provided also, and his *Majesty's* meanynge is, that the *Ordinary*

A.D. 1617. of Money for any Causes or Pretences
15 Jac. 1. whatsoever, Mayntenances, Champar-
 ties, Imbraeries, Oppressions, Vexa-
 tions, Conspiracies, Imbezelling, Race-
 ing or Defacing of any Bills, Pleadings,
 Orders, Rules, Proceedings or Records
 of the same Court, Escapes, Ryotts,
 Routs and unlawfull Assemblies, For-
 stalling and Engrossing, Corruptions,
 Falshoods, Frauds, unlawfull Hunting
 in Forests, Chaces, Parks and War-
 rens, not amending High-waies and
 Bridges, erecting of Cottages, taking
 in or keeping of Inmates, keeping of
 disordered Alehouses, and punish such
 Alehousekeepers, and all other Offen-
 ces, Contempts, Defaults, Conceal-
 ments and Misdemeanors, done or
 committed against the Lawes of this
 Realm by any Sheriffs, Justices of the
 Peace, Mayor, Bayliffs, Constables,
 Stewards, Escheators, Coroners, Gao-
 lers, Jurors, Cryers, Clerkes, or any
 of the Officers or Mynisters of Justice
 or their Deputies, or anie of them, or
 by any other Person or Persons of what
 degree soever they be within the said
Domynion and Principality of Wales
 and the Marches of the same, and the
 said Counties of *Gloucester, Worcester,*
Hereford, Salop and Monmouth, the Li-
 berties of the *Duchie of Lancaster* with-
 in the Counties aforesaid, the Cities of
Gloucester, Worcester and Hereford, the
 County of the Citie of *Gloucester,* the
Towne of Haverford West and the Coun-
 tie of the same; and to punish the
 same according to their Wildoms and
 Discretions, as well by Fyne and Ym-
 prisonment as otherwise, according to
 the Qualitie of their Offences, as to
 them shall seem meet; And further, the
 said *Lord President* or *Vice-President*
 and *Counsell* as is aforesaid, or any three
 of them at the least (whereof the said
Lord President or *Vice President* for
 the tyme being, or the *Cheif Justice of*
Chester to be one) in sort aforesaid, shall
 and may, from time to time, duly and
 diligently enquire or cause to be enqui-
 red within the Limits of their Juris-
 diction as is aforesaid, of all such as,
 under pretence and colour of takeing
 of any Musters of any Souldiers, or of
 Provision of Armour and Weapons,
 have unlawfullie aund indirectly ex-
 acted or shall exact any Sommes of
 Money or other Guiste whatsoever:
 And, upon due prooff thereof, the said
Lord President or *Vice-President* and
Counsell as is aforesaid, or any three of
 them (whereof the *Lord President* or
Vice President for the tyme being, or the

Cheif Justice of Chester to be one) shall A.D. 1617.
 not only constrayn such Officer or Of-
 ficers, Mynister or Mynisters, or other
 Persons whatsoever, to restore to the
 Partie or Parties of whom such Money
 is unlawfully exacted the double Va-
 lue of the thing that is or shall bee soe
 taken or received of him or them, but
 also shall punish them with Fyne and
 Ymprisonment according to their Dis-
 cretions and the Laws and Ordynances
 in that behalfe provyded.

And his *Majestie's* further Pleasure
 ys, and his Highnes doth, by theis
 Presents, give full Power and Authority
 to the said *Lord President Vice-Pre-*
sident and *Counsell*, or any such three of
 them as is aforesaid, to heare and de-
 termyne all manner of Perjuries com-
 mitted within the said Domynion Prin-
 cipalitie and Marches, Counties, Ci-
 ties, Towns, Places and Lymits aforesaid,
 or any of them, in such wise as
 the *Lord President* and *Counsell* there
 for the tyme being might have done,
 and used to do before the Statute made
 in the fiftie Yeare of the Raigne of the
 late *Queen Elizabeth*, touching the pu-
 nishing of Perjurie, soe that they set
 not uppon the Offendor or Offendors
 therein lesse Punynishment then is con-
 tayneid in the sayde Statute.

And whereas divers lewd and ma-
 licious Persons have heretofore, and of
 late days more and more, devysed,
 spread abroad, reported or published
 many false and seditious Tales, News,
 Sayings, Wrytings, Books, Letters and
 Libells, which amongst the People
 have wrought and hereafter may work
 great Mischief and Inconveniences, to
 the intent the like may be avoyded
 hereafter, and the Inventors and Set-
 ters forth thereof may be condignely
 punyshed; his *Majestie's* Pleasure is,
 that the said *Lord President* or *Vice-*
President and *Counsell* as is aforesaid,
 shall have due regard thereof; and
 that whensoever any such false and se-
 dycious Tales, News, Sayings, Wri-
 tings, Books, Letters or Libells shall
 bee devysed, reported, published or dis-
 persed with any the Lymits or Jurisdi-
 ctions aforesaid, That the Publishers Dis-
 persers and Reporters thereof be forth-
 with stayed, and all meanes used to at-
 tach them all from one toon other untill
 the first Author may be apprehended,
 and such Offendors shall bee duely o-
 penly punyshed by the said *Lord Presi-*
dent or *Vice-President* or *Counsell*, or any
 three of them (whereof the *Lord Pre-*
sident or *Vice-President* for the tyme
 being,

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